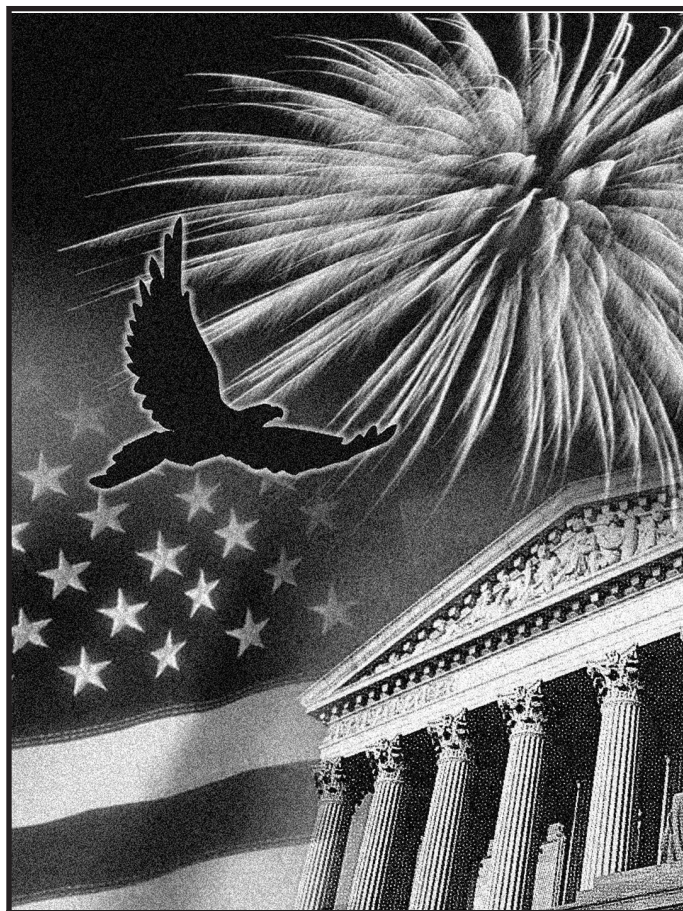




Publication 15-T

Federal Income Tax Withholding Methods

For use in **2026**



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Future Developments

For the latest information about developments related to Pub. 15-T, such as legislation enacted after it was published, go to [IRS.gov/Pub15T](https://www.irs.gov/pub15t).

What's New

2026 federal income tax withholding tables. The 2026 federal income tax withholding tables in this publication have been updated for changes made by P.L. 119-21, commonly known as the One Big Beautiful Bill Act, including the permanent extension of individual tax rates, the permanent extension of the increased standard deduction, and the permanent termination of personal exemptions, which were all originally enacted by the Tax Cuts and Jobs Act (P.L. 115-97).

2026 Form W-4. Form W-4, Employee's Withholding Certificate, has been updated for 2026 to account for new federal income tax deductions under P.L. 119-21 that are available to employees when they file their income tax returns. The 2026 Form W-4 was also updated to add a new checkbox below Step 4(c) for an employee to claim exemption from federal income tax withholding. Previously, the employee wrote "Exempt" below Step 4(c).

2026 Form W-4P. Form W-4P, Withholding Certificate for Periodic Pension or Annuity Payments, has been updated for 2026 to account for new federal income tax deductions under P.L. 119-21 that are available to payees when they

file their income tax returns. The 2026 Form W-4P was also updated to add a new checkbox below Step 4(c) for a payee to request no federal income tax withholding. Previously, the payee wrote “No withholding” below Step 4(c).

Withholding on qualified tips. For tax years beginning after 2024 and ending before 2029, P.L. 119-21 allows employees and self-employed individuals to deduct up to \$25,000 of qualified tips received in occupations that customarily and regularly received tips on or before December 31, 2024, on their income tax returns. Qualified tips are cash tips, which include voluntary cash or charged tips received from customers or, in the case of employees, through tip-sharing arrangements. Mandatory service charges added to the bill are not qualified tips. Employers must use an employee’s updated Form W-4, if one is submitted by the employee, and the federal income tax withholding procedures in this publication to allow the employee to account for their expected deduction and receive more money in each paycheck instead of waiting until filing their income tax return to receive the full benefit of this deduction. Tips are still generally subject to both the employer share and employee share of social security tax and Medicare tax if the tips received are \$20 or more per month.

Employers and other payers must file information returns (for example, Forms W-2, 1099-MISC, and 1099-NEC) with the Social Security Administration (SSA) or IRS, as applicable, and furnish statements to tip recipients showing cash tips received and the Treasury Tipped Occupation Code(s) of the tip recipient. However, the IRS has provided transition relief to employers and payers for the tax year 2025 reporting requirements. For more information, see Notice 2025-62, 2025-48 I.R.B. 740, available at [IRS.gov/irb/2025-48_IRB#NOT-2025-62](https://www.irs.gov/irb/2025-48_IRB#NOT-2025-62).

Withholding on qualified overtime compensation. For tax years beginning after 2024 and ending before 2029, P.L. 119-21 allows individuals (employees and other workers not treated as employees) to deduct up to \$12,500 (\$25,000 if married filing jointly) of qualified overtime compensation on their income tax returns. Qualified overtime is compensation that exceeds the regular rate of pay (such as the “half” portion of time-and-a-half compensation) that is required to be paid to an individual under section 7 of the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) of 1938. The FLSA provides that employers must generally pay covered, nonexempt employees at least one-and-a-half times their regular rate of pay for hours worked over 40 hours per week. For more information about overtime compensation, go to dol.gov/agencies/whd/overtime. Employers must use an employee’s updated Form W-4, if one is submitted by the employee, and the federal income tax withholding procedures in this publication to allow the employee to account for their expected deduction and receive more money in each paycheck instead of waiting until filing their income tax return to receive the full benefit of this deduction. Overtime compensation is still generally subject to both the employer share and employee share of social security tax and Medicare tax.

Employers and other payers must file information returns (for example, Forms W-2, 1099-MISC, and

1099-NEC) with the SSA or IRS, as applicable, and furnish statements to overtime recipients showing qualified overtime compensation paid during the year. However, the IRS has provided transition relief to employers and payers for the tax year 2025 reporting requirements. For more information, see [Notice 2025-62](https://www.irs.gov/irb/2025-62).

Reminders

IRS Tax Withholding Estimator. Employees and payees may use the IRS Tax Withholding Estimator, available at [IRS.gov/W4App](https://www.irs.gov/W4App), when completing their Form W-4 or their Form W-4P.

Form W-4P and Form W-4R. Form W-4P was redesigned for 2022. Form W-4P is now used only to make withholding elections for periodic pension or annuity payments. Previously, Form W-4P was also used to make withholding elections for nonperiodic payments and eligible rollover distributions. Withholding elections for nonperiodic payments and eligible rollover distributions are now made on Form W-4R, Withholding Certificate for Nonperiodic Payments and Eligible Rollover Distributions.

[Section 1](#) of this publication includes Worksheet 1B for payers to figure withholding on periodic payments of pensions and annuities based on a 2022 or later Form W-4P or a 2021 and earlier Form W-4P. Worksheet 1B is used with the STANDARD Withholding Rate Schedules in the 2026 Percentage Method Tables for Automated Payroll Systems and Withholding on Periodic Payments of Pensions and Annuities that are included in [section 1](#). If a payer is figuring withholding on periodic payments based on a 2021 or earlier Form W-4P, the payer may also figure withholding using the methods described in [section 3](#) and [section 5](#). For more information about Form W-4P, see [Form W-4P](#), later. Also, see [How To Treat 2021 and Earlier Forms W-4P as if They Were 2022 or Later Forms W-4P](#), later, for an optional computational bridge.

For more information about Form W-4R, see section 8 of Pub. 15-A, Employer’s Supplemental Tax Guide.

Computational bridge for Form W-4. Employers may use an optional computational bridge to treat 2019 and earlier Forms W-4 as if they were 2020 or later Forms W-4 for purposes of figuring federal income tax withholding. See [How To Treat 2019 and Earlier Forms W-4 as if They Were 2020 or Later Forms W-4](#), later, for more information.

Electronic submission of Forms W-4 and W-4P. You may set up a system to electronically receive Form W-4 or Form W-4P from an employee or payee.

For each form that you establish an electronic submission system for, you must meet each of the following five requirements.

1. The electronic system must ensure that the information received by you is the information sent by the employee or payee. The system must document all occasions of user access that result in a submission. In addition, the design and operation of the electronic system, including access procedures, must make it

reasonably certain that the person accessing the system and submitting the form is the person identified on the form.

2. The electronic system must provide exactly the same information as the paper form.
3. The electronic submission must be signed with an e-signature by the employee or payee whose name is on the form. The e-signature must be the final entry in the submission.
4. Upon request, you must furnish a hard copy of any completed electronic form to the IRS and a statement that, to the best of your knowledge, the electronic form was submitted by the named employee or payee. The hard copy of the electronic form must provide exactly the same information as, but need not be a facsimile of, the paper form. For Form W-4, the signature must be under penalty of perjury and must contain the same language that appears on the paper version of the form. The electronic system must inform the employee that they must make a declaration contained in the perjury statement and that the declaration is made by signing the Form W-4.
5. You must also meet all recordkeeping requirements that apply to the paper forms.

See [Substitute Submissions of Form W-4](#), later, for additional requirements specific to Form W-4; and [Substitute Submissions of Form W-4P](#), later, for additional requirements for a 2022 or later Form W-4P.

For more information on electronic submissions, see Regulations section 31.3402(f)(5)-1(c) (for Form W-4) and Announcement 99-6 (for Form W-4P). You can find Announcement 99-6 on page 24 of Internal Revenue Bulletin 1999-4 at [IRS.gov/pub/irs-irbs/irb99-04.pdf](https://www.irs.gov/pub/irs-irbs/irb99-04.pdf).

Introduction

This publication supplements Pub. 15, Employer's Tax Guide. It describes how to figure withholding using the Wage Bracket Method or Percentage Method, describes the alternative methods for figuring withholding, and provides the Tables for Withholding on Distributions of Indian Gaming Profits to Tribal Members.

Although this publication may be used in certain situations to figure federal income tax withholding on supplemental wages, the methods of withholding described in this publication can't be used if the 37% mandatory flat rate withholding applies or if the 22% optional flat rate withholding is used to figure federal income tax withholding. For more information about withholding on supplemental wages, see section 7 of Pub. 15.

Although this publication is used to figure federal income tax withholding on periodic payments of pensions and annuities, the methods of withholding described in this publication can't be used to figure withholding on non-periodic payments or withholding on eligible rollover distributions. Periodic payments are those made in installments at regular intervals over a period of more than 1 year. They

may be paid annually, quarterly, monthly, etc. For more information about withholding on pensions and annuities, see section 8 of Pub. 15-A.

Comments and suggestions. We welcome your comments about this publication and suggestions for future editions.

You can send us comments through [IRS.gov/FormComments](https://www.irs.gov/FormComments).

Or, you can write to:

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Although we can't respond individually to each comment received, we do appreciate your feedback and will consider your comments and suggestions as we revise our tax forms, instructions, and publications. **Don't** send tax questions, tax returns, or payments to the above address.

Getting answers to your tax questions. If you have a tax question not answered by this publication, check [IRS.gov](https://www.irs.gov) and [How To Get Tax Help](#) at the end of this publication.

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Photographs of Missing Children

The IRS is a proud partner with the [National Center for Missing & Exploited Children® \(NCMEC\)](#). Photographs of missing children selected by the Center may appear in this publication on pages that would otherwise be blank. You can help bring these children home by looking at the photographs and calling 1-800-THE-LOST (1-800-843-5678) if you recognize a child.

Form W-4

Beginning with the 2020 Form W-4, employees are no longer able to request adjustments to their withholding using withholding allowances. Instead, using the new Form W-4, employees provide employers with amounts to increase or

decrease the amount of taxes withheld and amounts to increase or decrease the amount of wage income subject to income tax withholding.

Form W-4 contains 5 steps. Every Form W-4 employers receive from an employee in 2020 or later should show a completed Step 1 (name, address, social security number (SSN), and filing status) and a dated signature in Step 5. Employees complete Steps 2, 3, and/or 4 only if relevant to their personal situations. Steps 2, 3, and 4 show adjustments that affect withholding calculations.

For employees who don't complete any steps other than Step 1 and Step 5, employers withhold the amount based on the filing status, wage amounts, and payroll period. But see [Exemption from withholding](#), later.

For employees completing one or more of Steps 2, 3, and/or 4 on Form W-4, adjustments are as follows.

Step 2. If the employee checks the box in Step 2, the employer figures withholding from the "Form W-4, Step 2, Checkbox" column in the Percentage Method or Wage Bracket Method tables. This results in higher withholding for the employee. If the employee chooses one of the other options from this step, the higher withholding is included with any other additional tax amounts **per pay period** in Step 4(c).

Tip: Consider advising employees to use the IRS Tax Withholding Estimator, available at [IRS.gov/W4App](https://irs.gov/W4App), when completing Form W-4 if they expect to work only part of the year; receive dividends, capital gains, social security, bonuses, or business income; are subject to the Additional Medicare Tax or Net Investment Income Tax; or they prefer the most accurate withholding for multiple job situations.

Step 3. Employers use the amount on this line as an **annual** reduction in the amount of withholding. Employers should use the amount that the employee entered as the total in Step 3 of Form W-4 even if it is not equal to the sum of any amounts entered on the left in Step 3 because the total may take into account other tax credits. If the Step 3 total is blank, but there are amounts entered in Step 3(a) or 3(b), the employer may ask the employee if leaving the line blank was intentional.

Steps 4(a) and 4(b). Employers increase the annual amount of wages subject to income tax withholding by the **annual** amount shown in Step 4(a) and reduce the annual amount of wages subject to income tax withholding by the **annual** amount shown in Step 4(b).

Step 4(c). Employers will increase withholding by the **per pay period** tax amount in Step 4(c).

Tip: At the beginning of each year, consider reminding employees to submit a new Form W-4 if they made a mid-year change to their Form W-4 based on their use of the IRS Tax Withholding Estimator available at [IRS.gov/W4App](https://irs.gov/W4App). Employees who made a mid-year change may be underwithheld or overwithheld once their Form W-4 is applied to the next full calendar year.

New employee fails to furnish Form W-4. A new employee who fails to furnish a Form W-4 will be treated as if they had checked the box for Single or Married filing separately in Step 1(c) and made no entries in Step 2, Step 3, or Step 4 of Form W-4. However, an employee who was paid wages before 2020 and who failed to furnish a Form W-4 should continue to be treated as Single and claiming zero allowances on a 2019 or earlier Form W-4.

Exemption from withholding. Employees who check the box for exemption from federal income tax withholding below Step 4(c) shall have no federal income tax withheld from their paychecks except in the case of certain supplemental wages. Generally, an employee may claim exemption from federal income tax withholding because they had no federal income tax liability last year and expect none this year. See the Form W-4 instructions for more information.

Substitute Submissions of Form W-4

General requirements for any system set up to electronically receive a Form W-4 or Form W-4P are discussed earlier under [Electronic submission of Forms W-4 and W-4P](#). This section provides specific requirements for substitute submissions of Form W-4.

Electronic Substitute to Form W-4

Employers aren't required to set up a system to electronically receive Form W-4 from an employee. If set up, however, the electronic system must meet all the requirements and guidelines set forth in regulations and specified by the IRS in forms, publications, and other guidance. The allowance of an electronic substitute for Form W-4 isn't a license to simplify or modify the Form W-4. In particular, electronic Form W-4 systems set up as a substitute to paper Forms W-4 must exactly replicate the text and instructions from the face of the paper Form W-4 beginning with Step 1(c) through Step 4(c) (inclusive), and the "Exempt from withholding" section below Step 4(c), and must allow an employee access to and use of all parts of the calculation shown on the paper Form W-4 and its worksheets.

No pop-ups or hoverboxes within those steps are permitted for displaying such required information, and if the electronic system has toggles for those steps that limit the amount of text that is viewable, the toggles must be off as the default. If the electronic system places steps on different pages, users must be required to go to each page before they may electronically sign the form. The electronic system must also include a hyperlink to Form W-4 on IRS.gov and/or include the pages 2–5 instructions and worksheets in their entirety in the electronic system interface itself (inclusion of only some of this information requires a link to the form).

Field required for claiming "Exempt." The electronic Form W-4 system must provide a checkbox for employees who are eligible and want to claim an exemption from withholding to certify that they are exempt immediately below or after Step 4(c) to allow users to elect no withholding

from their payments. The electronic checkbox must include the text used on Form W-4 but also stipulate both conditions that must be met for exemption or link directly to the conditions on page 2 of Form W-4.

Field required for nonresident alien status. You must provide a field for nonresident aliens to enter nonresident alien status.

Step 3 of 2026 Form W-4. To allow an employee access to and use of all parts of the calculation shown on the paper Form W-4, an electronic Form W-4 system can't restrict Step 3 to dollar increments based on the number of qualifying children or dependents the employee may claim for purposes of the child tax credit or credit for other dependents. The 2026 Instructions for Form W-4 indicate that an employee can include other tax credits for which they are eligible in Step 3 by adding an estimate of the credit amount for the year to the credits for dependents and entering the total amount. An employee should be allowed to include an estimate of tax credits other than the child tax credit or credit for other dependents when entering an amount in an electronic Form W-4 system for Step 3.

References to page numbers. Substitutes to the paper form need not replicate references on the face of the form to "page 2," "page 3," or "page 4" of the Form W-4 when those references are not applicable.

References to pages 2, 3, and 4, when not applicable to the substitute form, should be replaced by appropriate references. For example, an electronic substitute form that links directly to the deductions worksheet should not reference "page 4" but should provide a link to the deductions worksheet.

Requiring an SSN and other personal information already stored in employer's electronic system. An employer need not require an employee to resubmit an SSN or other personal information when completing an electronic Form W-4 as long as:

- The SSN and other personal information are stored in the employer's electronic system and the action being taken by the employee in the system is directly or indirectly linked to the electronically stored personal information; and
- The source of the SSN and other personal information stored in the employer's electronic system is a prior submission of a complete Form W-4 or the U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) Form I-9, Employment Eligibility Verification, that is signed by the employee under penalty of perjury.

The employer's electronic Form W-4 system must continue to ensure that the information received by the employer is the information sent by the employee and that the person accessing the system and furnishing the Form W-4 is the employee identified on the form. See [Electronic submission of Forms W-4 and W-4P](#), earlier. If an SSN or

other personal information is separately used by the electronic Form W-4 system to verify the identity of the employee, the employee will need to resubmit the information for that purpose.

Implementation of new guidelines. Employers aren't required to set up a system to electronically receive Form W-4 from an employee. If set up, however, the electronic system must meet all the requirements and guidelines set forth in regulations and specified by the IRS in forms, publications, and other guidance. When a guideline concerning what an electronic Form W-4 system must provide the employee is specified without an effective date, it is effective immediately and an employer must implement it in a reasonable amount of time. In most cases, a reasonable amount of time won't extend beyond 90 days.

Paper Substitute to Form W-4

In lieu of the prescribed form, an employer may prepare and provide to employees a substitute paper form the provisions of which are identical to those of the prescribed form, including the exact same wording from Steps 1(c)–4(c) (inclusive) and the "Exempt from withholding" section below Step 4(c), but only if the employer also:

- Provides employees with all the tables, instructions, and worksheets set forth in the Form W-4 in effect at that time; and
- Complies with all revenue procedures and other guidance prescribed by the Commissioner relating to substitute forms in effect at that time.

Guidelines that apply to electronic substitutes for Form W-4 don't necessarily apply to a paper substitute Form W-4. For example, a paper substitute Form W-4 must include the form's instructions and worksheets rather than providing a web address where the payee can find them on IRS.gov.

Employers are prohibited from accepting a substitute form developed by an employee, and an employee furnishing such form must be treated as failing to furnish a Form W-4.

How To Treat 2019 and Earlier Forms W-4 as if They Were 2020 or Later Forms W-4

Employers may use an optional computational bridge to treat 2019 and earlier Forms W-4 as if they were 2020 or later Forms W-4 for purposes of figuring federal income tax withholding. This computational bridge allows you to use computational procedures and data fields for a 2020 and later Form W-4 to arrive at the equivalent withholding for an employee that would have applied using the computational procedures and data fields on a 2019 or earlier Form W-4. You must make up to four adjustments to use this computational bridge.

1. Select the filing status in Step 1(c) of a 2020 or later Form W-4 that most accurately reflects the

employee's marital status on line 3 of a 2019 or earlier Form W-4. Treat the employee as "Single or Married filing separately" on a 2020 or later Form W-4 if the employee selected either "Single" or "Married, but withhold at higher single rate" as their marital status on their 2019 or earlier Form W-4. Treat the employee as "Married filing jointly" on a 2020 or later Form W-4 if the employee selected "Married" as their marital status on their 2019 or earlier Form W-4. You can't convert an employee to a filing status of "Head of household" using this computational bridge.

2. Enter an amount in Step 4(a) on a 2020 or later Form W-4 based on the filing status that you determined in (1) above when you converted the employee's marital status on a 2019 or earlier Form W-4. Enter \$8,600 if the employee's filing status is "Single or Married filing separately" or \$12,900 if the employee's filing status is "Married filing jointly."
3. Multiply the number of allowances claimed on line 5 of an employee's 2019 or earlier Form W-4 by \$4,300 and enter the result in Step 4(b) on a 2020 or later Form W-4.
4. Enter the additional amount of withholding requested by the employee on line 6 of their 2019 or earlier Form W-4 in Step 4(c) of a 2020 or later Form W-4.

Caution: This computational bridge applies only for Forms W-4 that were in effect on or before December 31, 2019, and that continue in effect because an employee didn't submit a 2020 or later Form W-4. If an employee is required, or chooses, to submit a new Form W-4, it doesn't change the requirement that the employee must use the current year's revision of Form W-4. Upon putting into effect a new Form W-4 from an employee, you must stop using this computational bridge for the applicable year of the new Form W-4. An employer using the computational bridge for a Form W-4 furnished by an employee must retain the Form W-4 for its records.

Lock-in letters. The IRS may have notified you in writing that the employee must use a specific marital status and is limited to a specific number of allowances in a letter (commonly referred to as a "lock-in letter") applicable before 2020. For more information about lock-in letters, see section 9 of Pub. 15. For lock-in letters based on 2019 or earlier Forms W-4, you may use this optional computational bridge to comply with the requirement to withhold based on the maximum withholding allowances and filing status permitted in the lock-in letter.

Nonresident alien employees. You may use this computational bridge to convert a nonresident alien employee's 2019 or earlier Form W-4 to a 2020 or later Form W-4. However, for the second adjustment of the computational bridge, always enter \$4,300 in Step 4(a) on a 2020 or later Form W-4. If you convert a nonresident alien employee's 2019 or earlier Form W-4 to a 2020 or later Form W-4, be sure to use Table 2 when adding an amount to their wages for figuring federal income tax withholding.

See [Withholding Adjustment for Nonresident Alien Employees](#), later, for more information.

For more information, see Treasury Decision 9924, 2020-44 I.R.B. 943, available at [IRS.gov/irb/2020-44 IRB#TD-9924](#).

Withholding Adjustment for Nonresident Alien Employees

Instruct nonresident aliens to see Notice 1392, Supplemental Form W-4 Instructions for Nonresident Aliens, before completing Form W-4.

Apply the procedure discussed next to figure the amount of federal income tax to withhold from the wages of nonresident alien employees performing services within the United States.

This procedure only applies to nonresident alien employees who have wages subject to income tax withholding.

Caution: Nonresident alien students from India and business apprentices from India aren't subject to this procedure.

Instructions. To figure how much federal income tax to withhold from the wages paid to a nonresident alien employee performing services in the United States, use the following steps.

Step 1. Determine if the nonresident alien employee has submitted a Form W-4 for 2020 or later or an earlier Form W-4. Then add to the wages paid to the nonresident alien employee for the payroll period the amount for the applicable type of Form W-4 and payroll period.

If the nonresident alien employee was first paid wages before 2020 and **has not** submitted a Form W-4 for 2020 or later, add the amount shown in Table 1 to their wages for calculating federal income tax withholding.

Table 1 Payroll period	Add additional
Weekly	\$226.90
Biweekly	453.80
Semimonthly	491.70
Monthly	983.30
Quarterly	2,950.00
Semiannually	5,900.00
Annually	11,800.00
Daily or Miscellaneous (each day of the payroll period)	45.40

If the nonresident alien employee has submitted a Form W-4 for **2020 or later** or was first paid wages in 2020 or later, add the amount shown in Table 2 to their wages for calculating federal income tax withholding.